

Unlocking Organizational Behavior 🧠

Your Essential Guide for Exam Success



Let's break down the science of people at work, one concept at a time.
This guide is built to help you **learn, remember, and ace** your exam.

Your Roadmap: From "Me" to "We" to "Us"

Organizational Behavior (OB) is the study of human behavior in organizational settings. We'll explore it across three key levels—think of them as zooming in and out on organizational life.

● The Individual ("Me")



How individuals behave. We'll cover topics like personality, motivation, and decision-making.

● The Group ("We")



How work groups behave. We'll explore teams, leadership, and communication.

● The Organization ("Us")



How the entire organization behaves. We'll look at culture, structure, and change.

The Micro Level: Understanding the Individual



What makes each employee tick? This section explores the internal factors that drive individual behavior and performance at work.

Topics Covered: Personality • Motivation • Attitudes & Emotions • Decision-Making

Personality: The Big Five Traits

Personality refers to the consistent patterns of behavior, cognition, and emotion in individuals. The **Big Five** model is the most common way to describe these traits.



Openness to Experience

Measures imagination, curiosity, and creativity.
High: Inventive.
Low: Cautious.



Conscientiousness

Measures organization, dependability, and discipline.
High: Efficient.
Low: Easy-going.



Extraversion

Measures sociability, assertiveness, and emotional expression.
High: Outgoing.
Low: Reserved.



Agreeableness

Measures trust, kindness, and compassion.
High: Friendly.
Low: Challenging.



Neuroticism

Measures sensitivity and emotional stability.
High: Sensitive.
Low: Secure.

Exam Tip: Remember the acronym **OCEAN** or **CANOE** to recall the Big Five traits.

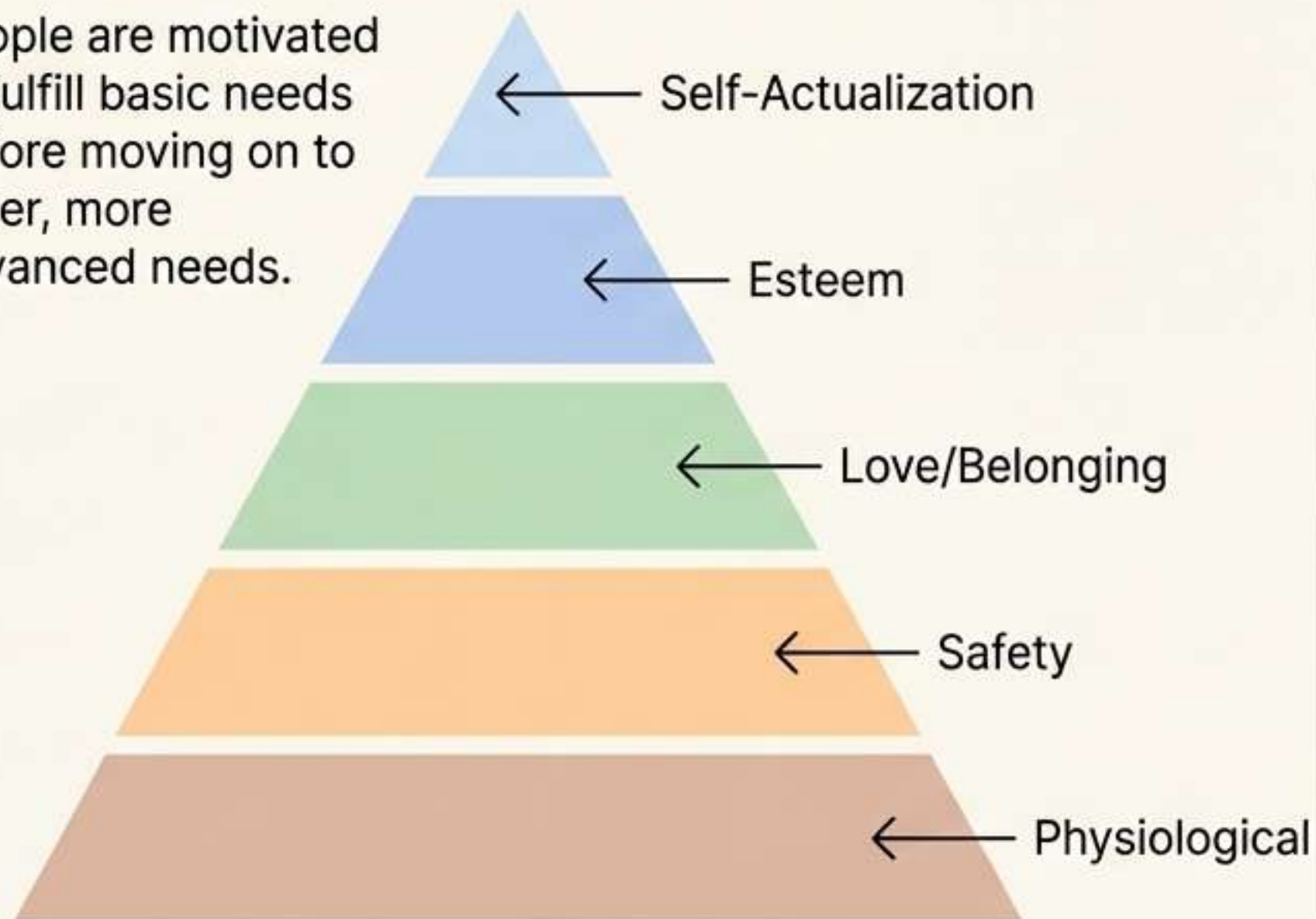
⚡ What Drives Us? Foundational Theories of Motivation



Spotlight on:
Abraham Maslow & Frederick Herzberg

Maslow's Hierarchy of Needs

People are motivated to fulfill basic needs before moving on to other, more advanced needs.



Herzberg's Two-Factor Theory

Job satisfaction and dissatisfaction are caused by separate sets of factors.

 Hygiene Factors	 Motivators
Things that <i>dissatisfy</i> if absent (e.g., salary, working conditions, job security). Their presence doesn't motivate, but their absence de-motivates.	Things that create satisfaction and <i>motivate</i> (e.g., achievement, recognition, responsibility, growth).

😊😡 Job Attitudes & Emotions

How employees feel about their work has a huge impact on their behavior.



Job Satisfaction

An employee's positive feelings about their job or specific facets of it (like pay or supervision).

Example: "Being happy with your manager and the projects you work on."



Organizational Commitment

The extent to which an employee feels attached to their organization and its goals.

Example: "Feeling proud to work for your company and wanting to stay long-term."



Emotional Labor

The requirement for an employee to display certain emotions (e.g., smiling at customers) even when they don't feel them.

Example: "A flight attendant remaining calm and polite with a rude passenger."

The Meso Level: Understanding Groups & Teams



What happens when individuals come together? This section explores the dynamics of teamwork, leadership, and interaction.

Topics Covered: Team Processes • Leadership Styles • Managerial Roles • Workplace Behavior

🔧 The Team Analyst's Toolkit: The IPO Model

The **Inputs-Processes-Outputs (IPO)** framework helps us understand what makes teams effective. It shows how initial conditions lead to team actions, which in turn lead to results.



Who's in Charge? A Snapshot of Leadership Theories

There is no single unifying theory of leadership. Instead, OB uses several models to explain how leaders influence others.

Ohio State Studies



Concept: Identified two key leader behaviors: **Consideration** (showing concern for subordinates) and **Initiating Structure** (assigning tasks and setting goals).

Contingency Theory



Concept: Argues that good leadership depends on a match between the leader's characteristics and the **situation**.

Path-Goal Theory



Concept: A contingency theory where the leader's job is to clarify the "path" to the subordinate's "goals" by choosing the right style for the situation.

Transformational Leadership



Concept: Focuses on leaders who **inspire** high levels of motivation and performance in followers, often through charisma and vision.



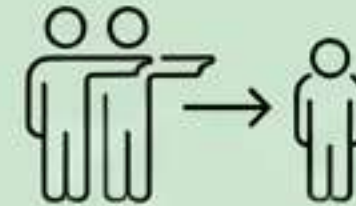
The Dark Side: Counterproductive & Mistreatment Behaviors

Counterproductive Work Behavior: Employee behavior that harms or intends to harm an organization.



Abusive Supervision

A supervisor engages in a sustained pattern of behavior that harms subordinates.



Workplace Bullying

A repeated pattern of harmful behaviors directed towards an individual, where the harmer has more power.



Workplace Incivility

Low-intensity discourteous and rude behavior with an ambiguous intent to harm.



Sexual Harassment

Behavior that denigrates or mistreats individuals on account of their gender, creating an offensive workplace.

The Macro Level: Understanding the Organization



How do all the pieces fit together? This section examines the "big picture" forces that shape an entire organization.

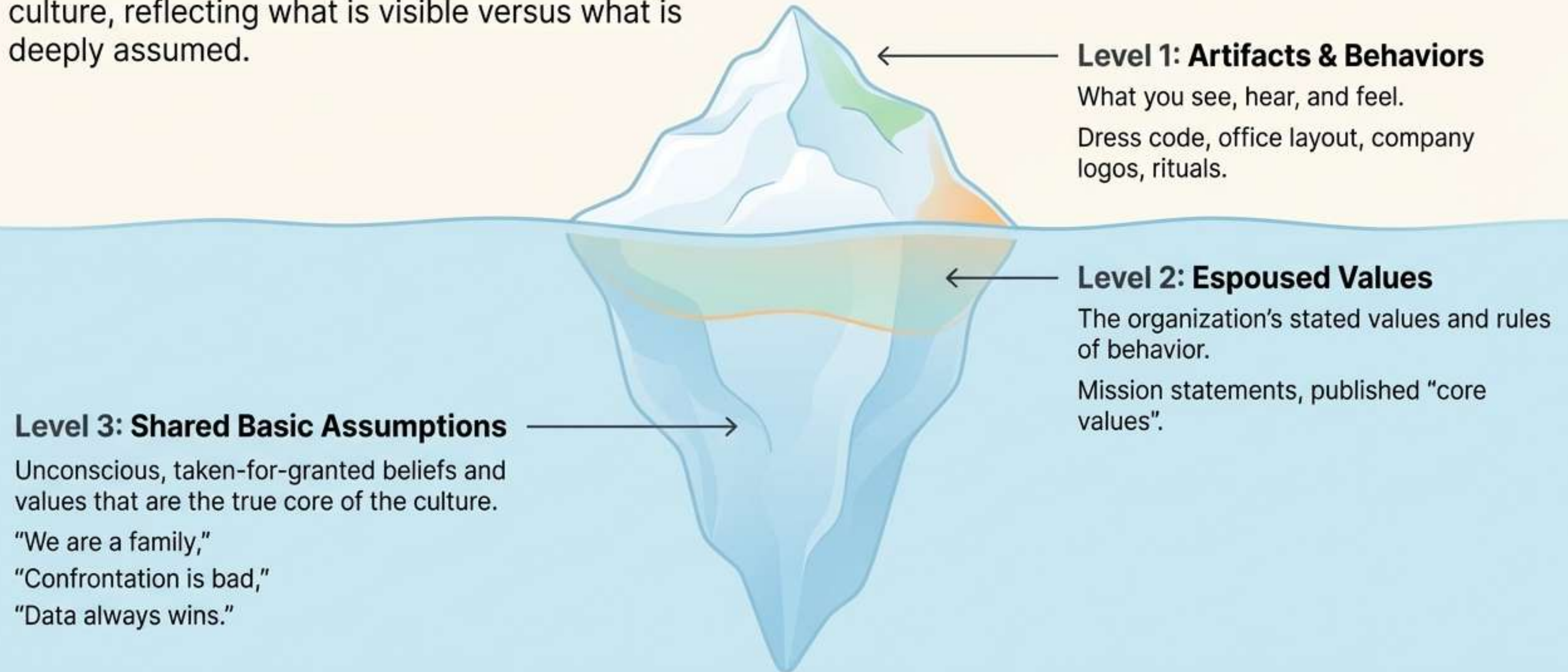
Topics Covered: Organizational Culture • Organizational Structure • Organizational Theory

Organizational Culture: The Iceberg Model



Spotlight on:
Edgar Schein

Schein identified three levels of organizational culture, reflecting what is visible versus what is deeply assumed.



Organizational Structure: The Logic of Bureaucracy



Spotlight on:
Max Weber

Weber argued that bureaucracy is the most technically efficient form of organization, based on **rational-legal authority**.

Key Principles of Bureaucracy

- ✓ **Formal Hierarchy:** Clear chain of command.
- ✓ **Management by Rules:** Control through formal regulations.
- ✓ **Functional Specialty:** Organization is divided by job function.
- ✓ **Impersonal Environment:** Rules are applied to all members equally.
- ✓ **Technical Qualifications:** People are selected and promoted based on skills, not personal connections.

A Quick History of OB



Theorist: **Frederick Taylor**

Concept: Advocated for maximizing task efficiency through the "scientific method," like time and motion studies. This was refined by **Frank & Lillian Gilbreth**.

1920s-1930s - The Hawthorne Studies



Theorists: **Maslow, Herzberg, McGregor**

Concept: Motivation, work performance, and job satisfaction became a central focus of OB research.

Early 1900s - Scientific Management



Theorist: **Elton Mayo**

Concept: Discovered the "**Hawthorne Effect**": productivity increased when workers were being studied, regardless of the conditions. This shifted focus to social relationships and job content.

1940s-1950s - The Rise of Motivation

✨ The Ultimate OB Exam Cheat Sheet



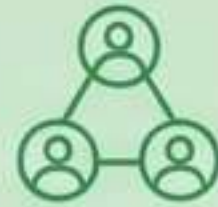
● MICRO (The Individual)

Personality: Big Five (OCEAN) 😊

Motivation: Maslow (Hierarchy), Herzberg (2-Factor), Equity Theory 📈💰

Attitudes: Job Satisfaction, Org. Commitment 👍❤️

Decisions: Bounded Rationality, Satisficing (H. Simon) 🧠✅



● MESO (The Group)

Teams: IPO Model (Inputs → Processes → Outputs) ⚙️🎯

Leadership: Contingency Theory, Transformational 🏰🚀

Roles: Mintzberg's 3 Managerial Roles (Interpersonal, Informational, Decisional) 🤝📄

Behavior: Counterproductive Work Behavior, Bullying vs. Incivility 😡🛑



● MACRO (The Organization)

Culture: Schein's 3 Levels (Artifacts, Values, Assumptions) 💎🔍

Structure: Weber's Bureaucracy (Hierarchy, Rules, Impersonality) 🏛️📋

Theory: Systems Theory, Organizational Ecology 🌐🌳

History: 🕒 Taylor (Scientific Mgt.), Mayo (Hawthorne Effect) ⌚💡